

Northgate University Information Asset Owners Handbook

An ISO/IEC 27001:2013 aligned document · Internal Use Only

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1. Purpose

This handbook explains the role and responsibilities of an Information Asset Owner (IAO) at Northgate University ("the University"). It provides practical guidance for those accountable for the University's information assets and supports the consistent application of the University's information security controls in line with ISO/IEC 27001:2013 Annex A.8.1.

2. Scope

This handbook applies to all members of staff designated as Information Asset Owners and to the information assets within their areas of responsibility. It operates within the University's information security policy framework.

3. What is an Information Asset?

An information asset is a body of information, or a system that holds or processes it, that has value to the University and therefore warrants protection. Examples include student and staff records, research data, finance and HR systems, databases, applications, and the information they contain.

4. The Role of the Information Asset Owner

Every information asset has a single, named Information Asset Owner — normally the manager of the function that relies on it. The IAO is accountable for ensuring the asset is properly identified, classified, protected, and used, even where day-to-day operation is delegated. The role is central to the University's information security management system: it places accountability for each asset with someone who understands its value and use (ISO/IEC 27001:2013 A.8.1.2).

5. Your Responsibilities at a Glance

As an Information Asset Owner, you are responsible for the following across each of your assets:

Responsibility	What it means	Reference
Inventory	Keep the asset's entry in the information asset register accurate and current.	A.8.1.1
Classification	Assign and review the asset's classification.	NGU-POL-8.2
Risk	Identify, assess, and formally accept risks to the asset.	NGU-POL-4.1
Access	Approve and review who can access the asset.	NGU-POL-9.1
Handling & use	Ensure the asset is handled and used appropriately.	A.8.1.3
Incidents	Support the response to incidents affecting the asset.	NGU-POL-16.1
Suppliers	Approve and oversee supplier access to the asset.	NGU-POL-15.1

6. The Asset Lifecycle

You manage your assets across their lifecycle:

- **Identification.** Record the asset in the information asset register (A.8.1.1).
- **Classification.** Assign a classification based on sensitivity (A.8.2).
- **Protection and use.** Ensure appropriate controls, handling, and acceptable use (A.8.1.3).
- **Review.** Keep the register entry, classification, and access current.
- **Disposal or return.** Ensure information is securely disposed of, and assets returned, at end of life (A.8.1.4).

7. Classifying Your Assets

Classification drives how an asset must be protected. Assign one of the following, and review it whenever the asset or its use changes:

Classification	Use it for
Public	Information approved for release to anyone.
Internal Use Only	Day-to-day information for staff and students; the default where unclassified.
Restricted	Information limited to specific roles or teams for operational reasons.
Confidential	Personal, sensitive, or business-critical information for named individuals only.

Full definitions and handling requirements are in the Information Classification Policy (NGU-POL-8.2).

8. Managing Risk to Your Assets

You are responsible for the information security risks to your assets. Working with the information security team, you identify threats and vulnerabilities, assess risk using the University's methodology, agree treatment, and formally accept residual risk. The process is defined in the Information Security Risk Management Methodology (NGU-POL-4.1).

9. Managing Access to Your Assets

You decide who may access your assets, on the basis of least privilege and need-to-know. You approve access requests, review access rights at least every six months, and ensure access is removed when staff leave or change role. Access controls are set out in the Access Control Policy (NGU-POL-9.1).

10. Acceptable Use and Return of Assets

You ensure your assets are used only for legitimate University purposes and handled in line with their classification (A.8.1.3). When staff or third parties leave, you ensure that any University assets and information in their possession are returned or securely destroyed (A.8.1.4).

11. When Something Goes Wrong

If you become aware of a security incident, weakness, or suspected breach affecting your assets, report it immediately through the University's incident channel and support the response. The process is set out in the Information Security Incident Management Policy (NGU-POL-16.1).

12. Where to Get Help

- **Information Security Team (CISO).** Advice on controls, risk, and this handbook.
- **Data Protection Officer (DPO).** Advice on personal data and data protection obligations.
- **IT Service and System Administrators.** Implementing access and technical controls.
- **Risk Register Owner.** Recording and tracking risks to your assets.

13. Compliance

Acting as an Information Asset Owner is a University responsibility. Where assets are not properly classified, protected, or managed, the University's information and its compliance obligations are placed at risk. Support is available from the information security team to help you meet these responsibilities.

14. Related Policies and Standards

- Information Security Policy (NGU-POL-5.1)
- Information Classification Policy (NGU-POL-8.2)
- Information Security Risk Management Methodology (NGU-POL-4.1)
- Access Control Policy (NGU-POL-9.1)
- Information Security Incident Management Policy (NGU-POL-16.1)
- Supplier Security Policy (NGU-POL-15.1)
- ISO/IEC 27001:2013 — Annex A.8 (A.8.1, A.8.2)

15. Document Version History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Change
1.0	01 June 2026	Chief Information Security Officer	Initial issue. Defines the Information Asset Owner role and responsibilities.